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The Entertainers

Must-have software for playing, encoding and managing audio and video on your PC

If the PC is where your entertainment is, here is a way to enhance the experience. Each of these hand-picked software is easy to use and provides several features to pump up the capabilities of your system for a smooth playback, high-quality recording and encoding, and smart media management.

Music on your desk

A relatively recent development, online radio came up around a year ago, when broadband was just making an appearance. Spinner 4.0 (www.spinner.com) is a free online music player with thousands of songs categorised into over a hundred channels. You can choose from Techno, Country, Hip-Hop, Latin, etc and enjoy a continuous stream of music right on your desktop, without installing an additional software or plugin. It also hosts a feature that gives you complete information about your favourite artiste or song.

MP3 players are increasingly becoming the popular carriers of music for those on the move. But you need to convert your music into MP3 format first and you can't trust just any software to do that. You need high-quality conversion that

will optionally encode MP3 files with variable bitrates, if your player supports it. AudioCatalyst 2.1 (www.xingtech.com) converts audio CDs to MP3s in one easy step and incorporates a player and playlist manager. It's very fast and features several functions for enhancing the audio. You can also use AudioCatalyst for encoding MP3s from other file formats such as WAV.

Winamp (www.winamp.com) needs no introduction; you're probably playing it on your desktop right now, and if you aren't, waste no time! Not only does this very light player have an excellent suite of features, but with its support for plugins, it's scalable to any level. The latest version, Winamp 3.0 (currently in beta stage), supports video playback, making it a complete multimedia suite! There are virtually thousands of plugins available

Find it on the Mindware CD
under Software > Multimedia

Spinner 4.0, AudioCatalyst
2.1, Winamp 2.80, PowerDVD XP 4.0,
SmartRipper 2.41, aMPEG2Avi GUI 2.5
Beta 1, EasyDivX 0.82, TMPEGEnc
2.57.41.146, VCD Cutter 4.03, MUSIC-
MATCH Jukebox 7.2, eDonkey 6.1

